

Customers are opting for smartwatches with GPS tracking, heart rate and BP monitoring. LTE-enabled models add hands-free convenience, making smartphones optional for short excursions.

**Q** How has the Indian consumer behaviour around travel tech changed, especially with the rise of wellness-driven vacations?

**Zeba Khan:** Over the past year, Indian consumers have embraced domestic travel and wellness-driven vacations like never before, and this shift is clearly reflected in their tech choices. Consumers are increasingly choosing smartwatches to track hydration, step count, sleep quality, and calorie burn, making them essential companions for treks, retreats, and mindful getaways. Tech products with features like BP and heart rate monitoring, GPS tracking, and LTE calling are seeing higher adoption, enabling a more connected and hands-free experience during travel.

**Q** Any insights on smart wearables or fitness gadgets that people are purchasing more during their vacation planning phase?

**Zeba Khan:** Smartwatches are increasingly becoming a travel essential for Indian consumers, with vacation planners prioritizing features like built-in GPS for phone-free tracking, long battery life for uninterrupted use, BP and ECG monitoring for health insights, and LTE calling for hands-free convenience. This reflects a growing preference for smart wearables that combine fitness, safety, and connectivity – making them perfect companions for wellness getaways and outdoor adventures.



**Q** Are there specific travel accessories or consumer tech categories seeing unexpected demand this season?

**Zeba Khan:** This travel season, demand for travel-friendly tech is seeing a notable shift. Active Noise Cancellation (ANC)-enabled earbuds have seen 3x higher adoption compared to non-ANC options, with new launches like Noise's Masterbuds series with Sound by Bose bringing immersive, great-sounding audio to customers. Meanwhile, the rise in road trips has fueled a 2x YoY growth in dash camera adoption, as travellers prioritize safety and content capture. These trends highlight a growing consumer focus on comfort, utility, and safety during travel.

**Q** How is Amazon leveraging tech innovations like AI or predictive analytics to recommend travel-ready gadgets and accessories to shoppers?

**Zeba Khan:** Our AI-powered shopping assistant, Rufus, helps enhance the shopping experience for customers across all their travel needs. Rufus supports customers in discovering and choosing travel-ready gadgets – from tablets to speakers – by answering questions about product features, comparing

options, and interpreting reviews. We also have curated stores where customers can browse best-selling products by category or scenario, making the pre-travel tech checklist easier to navigate than ever before.

**Q** With the growing popularity of adventure tourism in India, how is Amazon catering to their unique tech needs?

**Zeba Khan:** We have a robust selection of action cameras ranging across both premium and affordable segments from top brands, catering to both adventure and travel enthusiasts. These cameras offer 360-degree capture, invisible selfie sticks, HyperSmooth stabilisation, and waterproofing up to 100ft – empowering thrill-seekers to document cliff dives, mountain biking, and underwater exploration alike. We're seeing more young travellers wanting to not just experience, but share their adventures – and we're making that easier.

Zeba Khan's insights paint a vivid picture of the modern Indian traveller – one who's connected, conscious, and increasingly curated. Whether it's tracking vitals on a smartwatch during a jungle trek, blasting indie playlists from a JBL on a secluded beach, or capturing panoramic drone footage over Ladakh, travel today is a tech-enabled tapestry of personal storytelling.

This May, as you pack for your next getaway – domestic, international, or entirely mental – spare a thought for the tech companions riding shotgun in your backpack. Not just the tools that get you from A to B, but the gadgets that shape how you see, hear, and remember your journey. **d**